

TAB 35



Board of Education Report

File #: Res-076-24/25, **Version:** 1**Agenda Date:** 5/13/2025**In Control:** Board of Education

Ms. Newbill - Recognizing May as Mental Health Awareness Month and Focusing on Student Mental Health (Res-076-24/25) (Waiver of Board Rule 72)

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District has a goal of reaching 100 percent graduation and must provide a learning environment that promotes social-emotional learning and support for students and adults;

Whereas, Childhood and adolescence are critical times for physical and mental development, and the development of good mental health is important for overall good health and well-being throughout the lifespan;

Whereas, While approximately 1 in 5 children have a diagnosable mental disorder and approximately 1 in 10 children have a serious emotional or behavioral disorder that is severe enough to cause substantial impairment in functioning at home, at school, or in the community;

Whereas, Chronic absenteeism in students is strongly linked to mental health challenges, with studies showing that students with poor mental health are more likely to be absent from school. Conversely, chronic absenteeism can also exacerbate or trigger mental health issues, creating a cycle of negative consequences;

Whereas, A screening of 572 District students revealed that 88 percent reported experiencing three or more traumatic events, with 55 percent showing symptoms of PTSD, depression, or anxiety, [according to the L.A. Trust for Children's Health <https://www.thelatruster.org/articles/mental-health-is-a-key-concern-as-students-return-to-class>](https://www.thelatruster.org/articles/mental-health-is-a-key-concern-as-students-return-to-class);

Whereas, It is currently estimated that 70 to 80 percent of children with mental health disorders may not receive any care at all;

Whereas, In 2021, the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention's Youth Risk Behavior Surveillance System for LAUSD students indicated that 42 percent of high school students reported a prolonged sense of sadness or hopelessness every day for two or more continuous weeks; 22 percent of middle school and 18 percent of high school students seriously considered attempting suicide; and over 9 percent of middle school and 10 percent of high school students attempted suicide;

Whereas, The District envisions an environment where every student has equitable access to timely, effective, and culturally responsive mental health and wellness services seamlessly integrated into the school community;

Whereas, The District's Student and Family Wellness Hotline, which was created during the pandemic to provide families continued access to wellness services, received over 35,000 calls between April

2020 and June 2022 for a wide range of supports, including mental health, attendance and enrollment, access to basic needs, specialized student programs and immunization information;

Whereas, Schools serve as vital gateways to connecting students and families with mental health services. By fostering strong partnerships with over 60 community mental health agencies, including the District's School Mental Health Clinics and Wellness Centers, the District can ensure that students and their families have easy access to support;

Whereas, Families can call the Student and Family Wellness Hotline at 213-241-3840 to get access to mental health services, and other essential school and community resources. The wellness line is open weekdays from 8-4:30pm and closed on major holidays;

Whereas, As part of the 2022-26 Strategic Plan, Los Angeles Unified called for prioritizing telehealth programs, allowing students to connect to health care professionals through video conferencing technology and the District began offering telehealth services to its schools in the fall 2023;

Whereas, Families can directly refer their children to our School Mental Health Clinics and Wellness Centers for individual, family, and group counseling services. These services are available both in-person and through telehealth; and

Whereas, Each LAUSD Region is supported by a mental health team, including Psychiatric Social Workers based on most school campuses. These professionals are ready to assist families in accessing mental health services both at their child's school and within their community; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District hereby declares May as Mental Health Awareness Month and directs the Superintendent and District staff, to inform families of the resources and activities available through the District promoting education and awareness of the mental health needs of our students and families.